

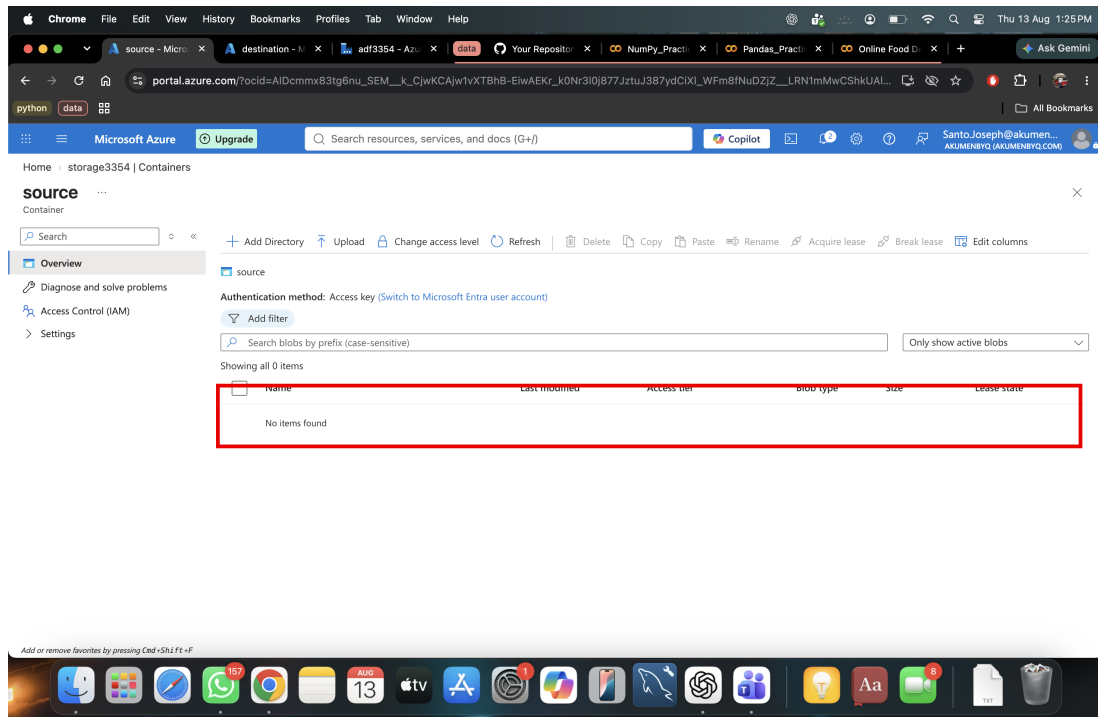
Copying Blob Files with Azure Data Factory's Copy Data Activity

Two walkthroughs: filtering by filename prefix, and filtering with a wildcard file path — copying files from a source container to a destination container

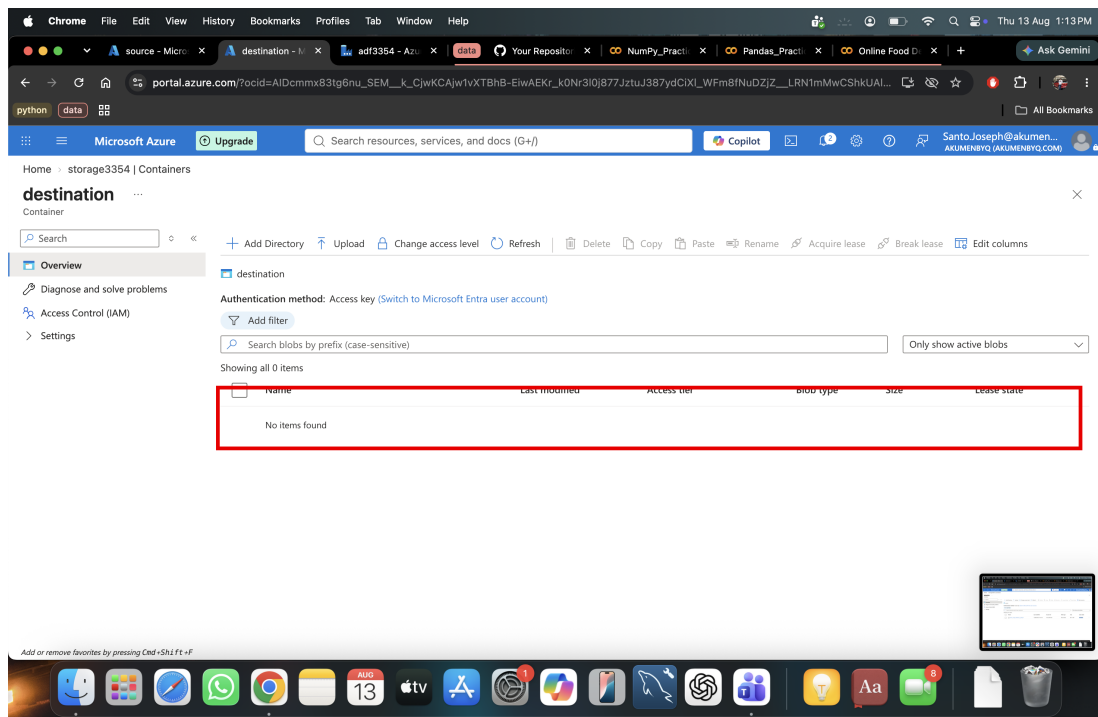
This guide documents two Copy Data exercises in Azure Data Factory. The red boxes on each screenshot mark the exact control or result being discussed in that step.

Part 1 — Copying files filtered by a filename prefix

Both the **source** and **destination** containers in the storage account start out empty, confirmed from their Overview pages.



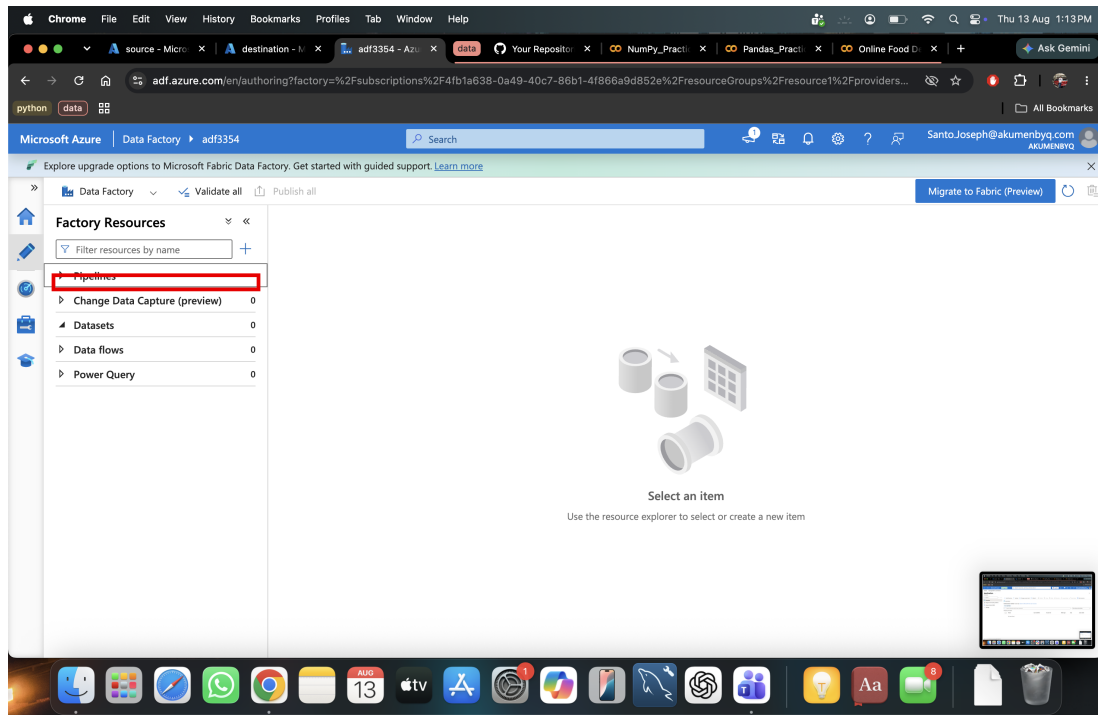
Step 1 — The source container has no items yet.



Step 2 — The destination container is also empty at the start.

Step 3 — Open the pipeline canvas

In Data Factory Studio (**adf3354**), open **Factory Resources** → **Pipelines** to create or select a pipeline. The highlighted **Pipelines** node is where new pipelines are added from.



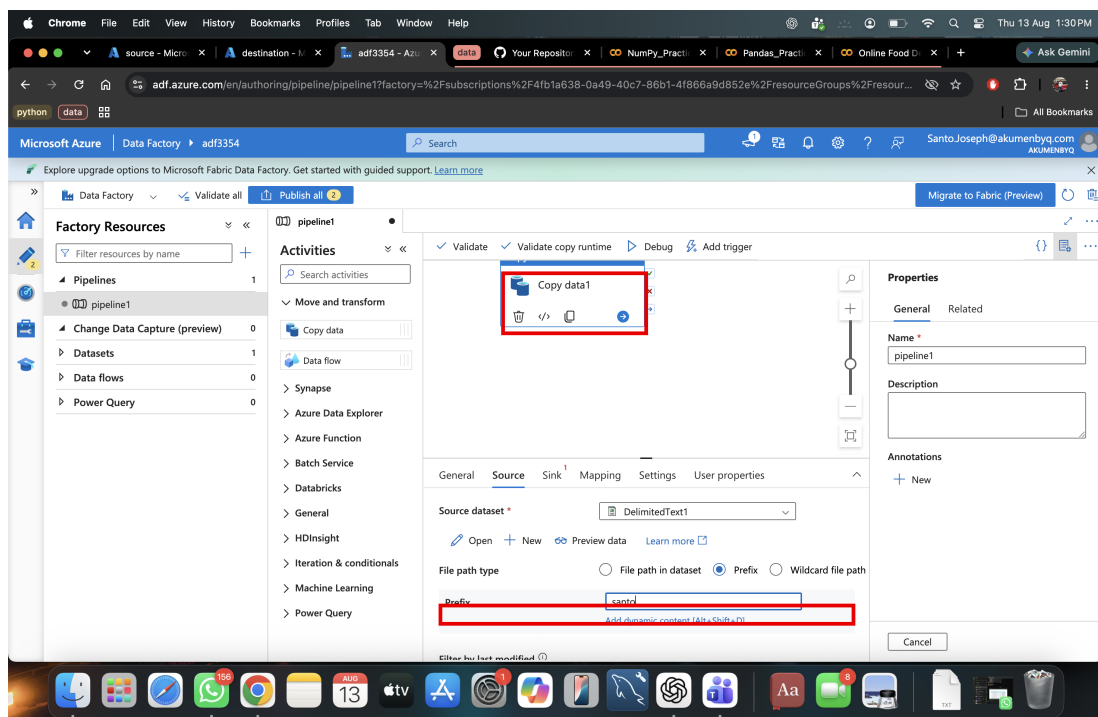
The empty pipeline canvas, with Pipelines highlighted in Factory Resources.

Step 4 — Add a Copy data activity and filter by prefix

Drag a **Copy data** activity onto the canvas (named **Copy data1**). On its **Source** tab, set the dataset to **DelimitedText1**, choose **File path type** → **Prefix**, and enter:

```
santo
```

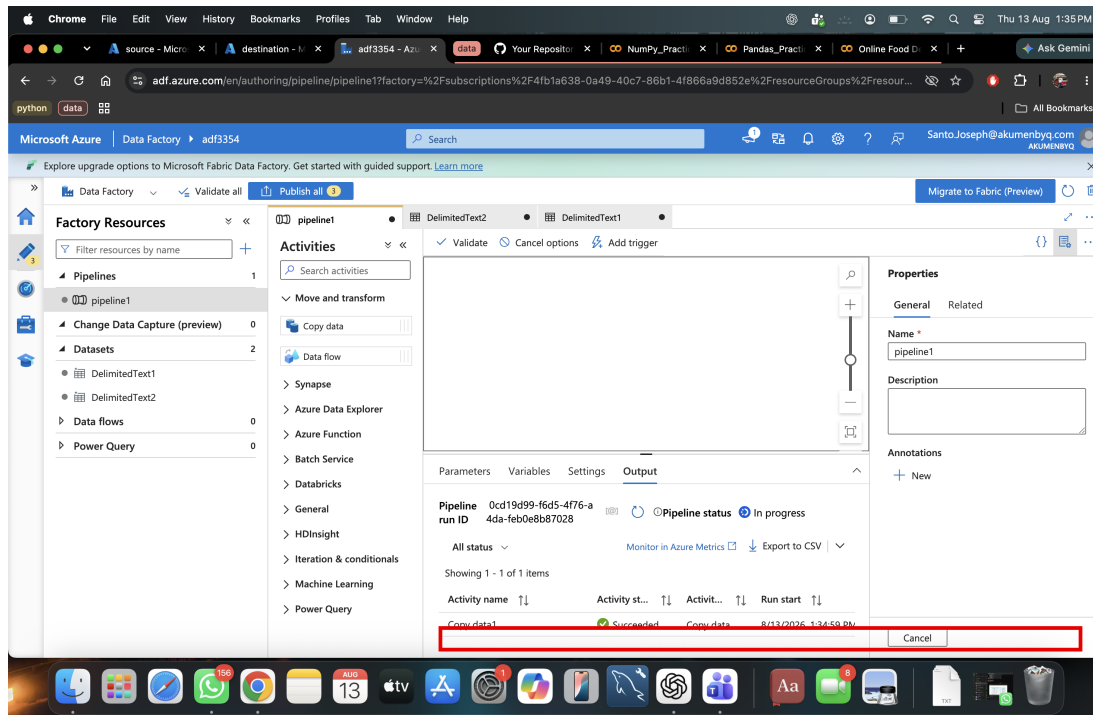
This tells the activity to copy only blobs in the source container whose filenames start with “santo”.



Copy data1 activity, with the Prefix field set to "santo".

Step 5 — Debug the pipeline

Click **Debug** to run the pipeline. The Output tab shows **Copy data1** finishing with a **Succeeded** status.



Debug output confirming the Copy data1 activity succeeded.

Step 6 — Verify the destination container

Refreshing the **destination** container shows exactly the files whose names start with “santo” — **santo 1.txt**, **santo 2.txt**, and **santo 3.txt** — were copied over from the source container.

Chrome browser window showing the Microsoft Azure portal. The page displays the 'destination' container details, including authentication method (Access key) and a table of blobs. The table lists three files: 'santo 1.txt', 'santo 2.txt', and 'santo 3.txt', all of which are highlighted with a red box.

Name	Last modified	Access tier	Blob type	Size	Lease state
santo 1.txt	13/08/2026, 13:35:14	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	20 B	Available
santo 2.txt	13/08/2026, 13:35:14	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	49 B	Available
santo 3.txt	13/08/2026, 13:35:14	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	65 B	Available

The three prefix-matched files now present in the destination container.

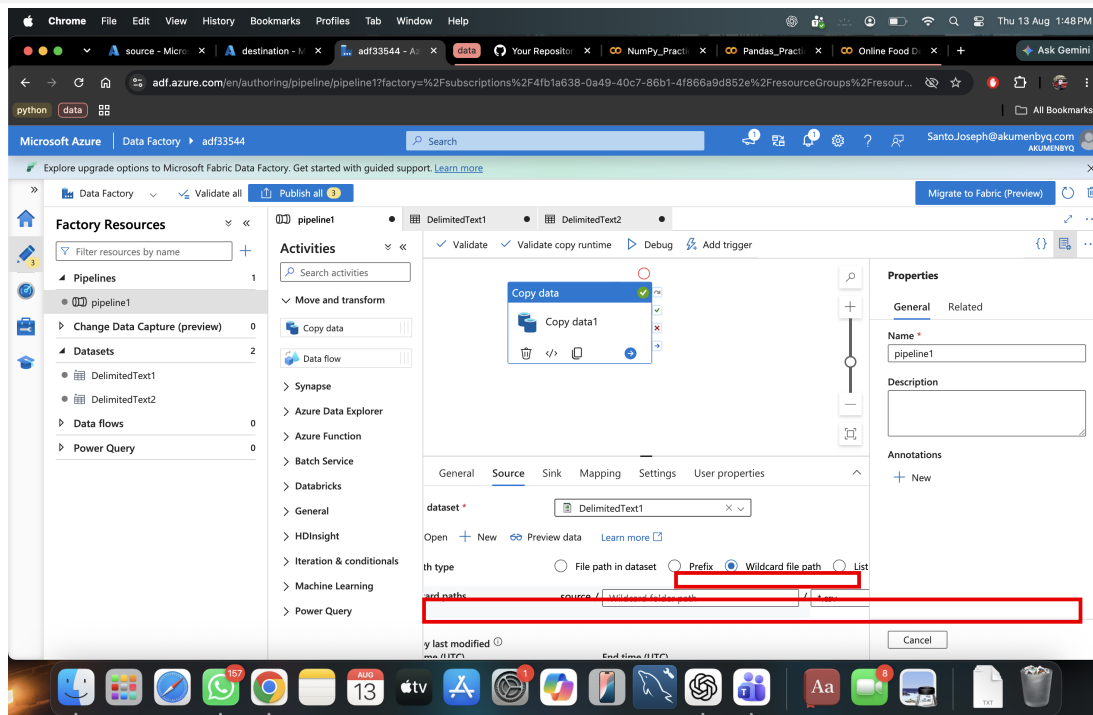
Part 2 — Copying files filtered by a wildcard file path

A second Data Factory (**adf33544**) demonstrates the alternative approach: instead of a prefix, the Copy data activity uses a **wildcard file path** to match files by pattern.

Step 7 — Configure the source with a wildcard path

On the Copy data1 activity's **Source** tab, choose **File path type** → **Wildcard file path**, and set the wildcard folder path to the **source** folder with a file filter of:

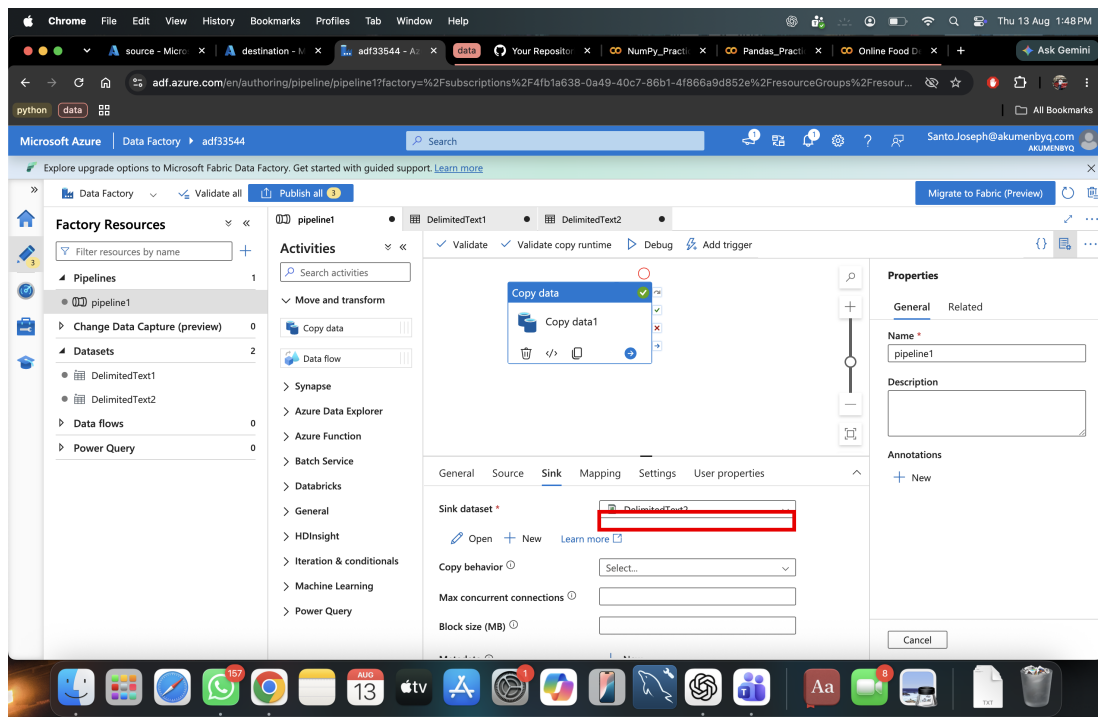
```
*.CSV
```



Wildcard file path selected, matching source/*.CSV.

Step 8 — Configure the sink dataset

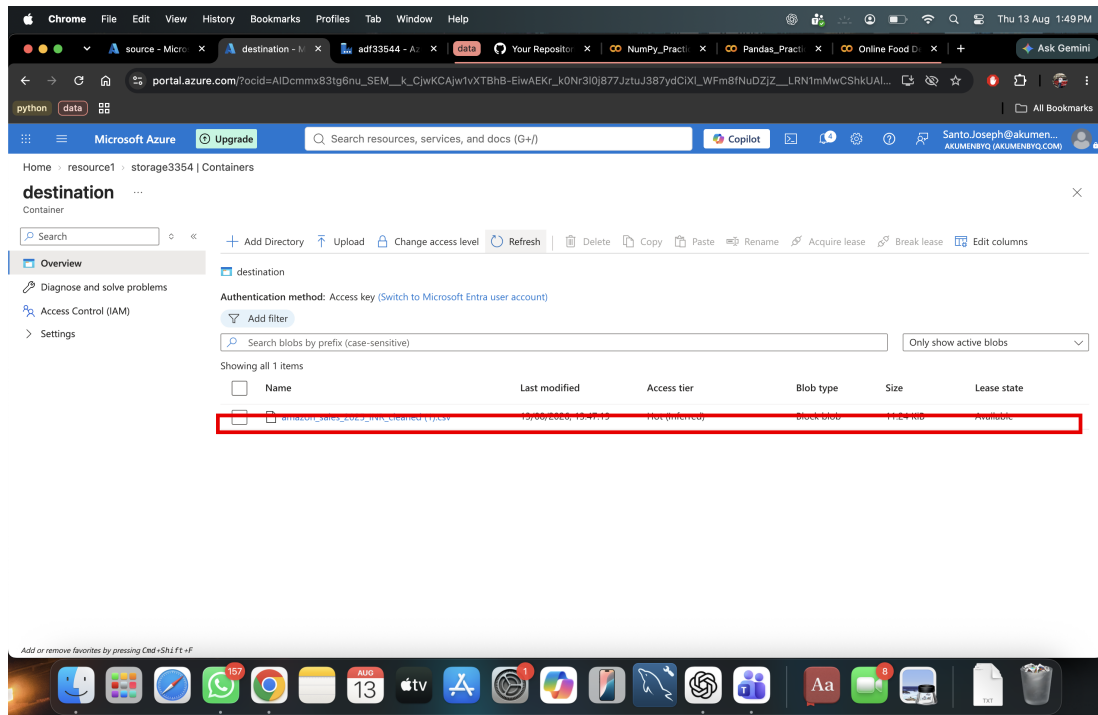
On the **Sink** tab, set the **Sink dataset** to **DelimitedText2**, which points at the destination container.



Sink dataset set to DelimitedText2.

Step 9 — Verify the destination container

After running the pipeline, the destination container now contains the CSV file matched by the wildcard: **amazon_sales_2025_INR_cleaned (1).csv**.



The CSV file copied into the destination container via the wildcard filter.

Step 10 — Upload an additional file to the source container

A new file, **list.txt**, is uploaded to the **source** container. The confirmation banner shows the upload succeeded, and the file now appears alongside the existing blobs.

Chrome browser window showing the Microsoft Azure portal. The page displays the 'source' container under 'storage3354'. A notification at the top right states: 'Successfully uploaded blob(s). Successfully uploaded 1 blob(s)'. The table below lists the blobs in the container:

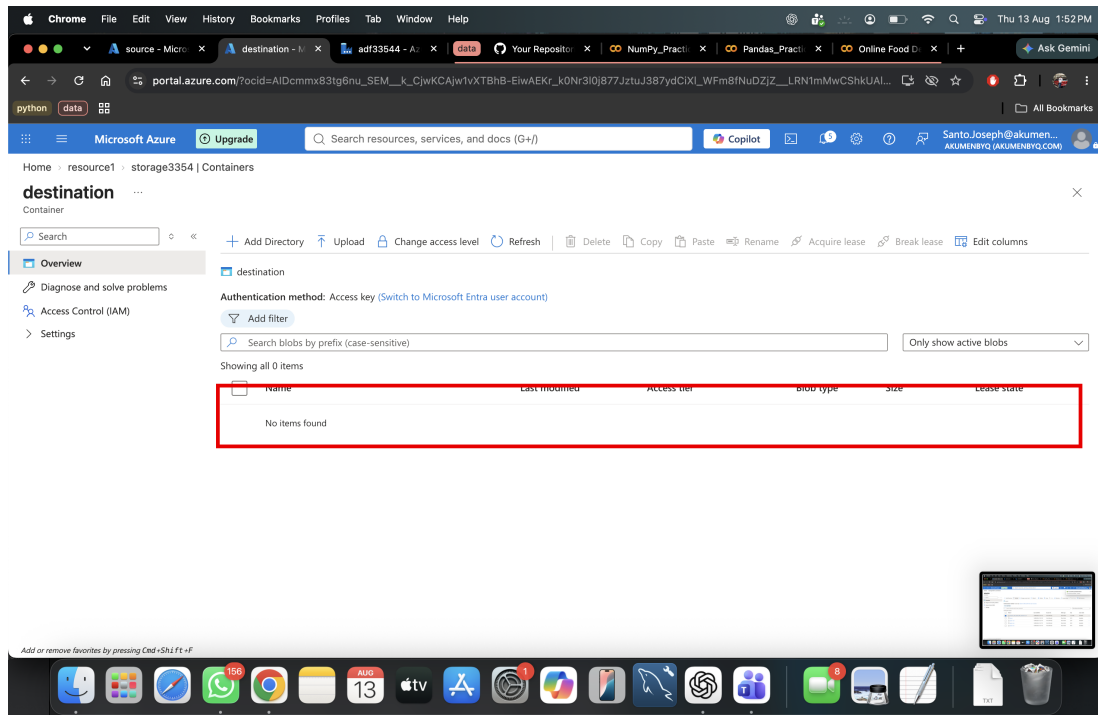
Name	Last modified	Access tier	Blob type	Size	Lease state
amazon_sales_2025_INR_cleaned (1).csv	13/08/2026, 13:27:19	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	11.24 KiB	Available
list.txt	13/08/2026, 13:27:19	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	61 B	Available
santo 1.txt	13/08/2026, 13:27:19	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	20 B	Available
santo 2.txt	13/08/2026, 13:27:19	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	49 B	Available
santo 3.txt	13/08/2026, 13:27:19	Hot (Inferred)	Block blob	65 B	Available

The 'list.txt' row is highlighted with a red box. The macOS dock is visible at the bottom of the screen.

Upload confirmation and the new list.txt file in the source container.

Step 11 — Reset the destination container

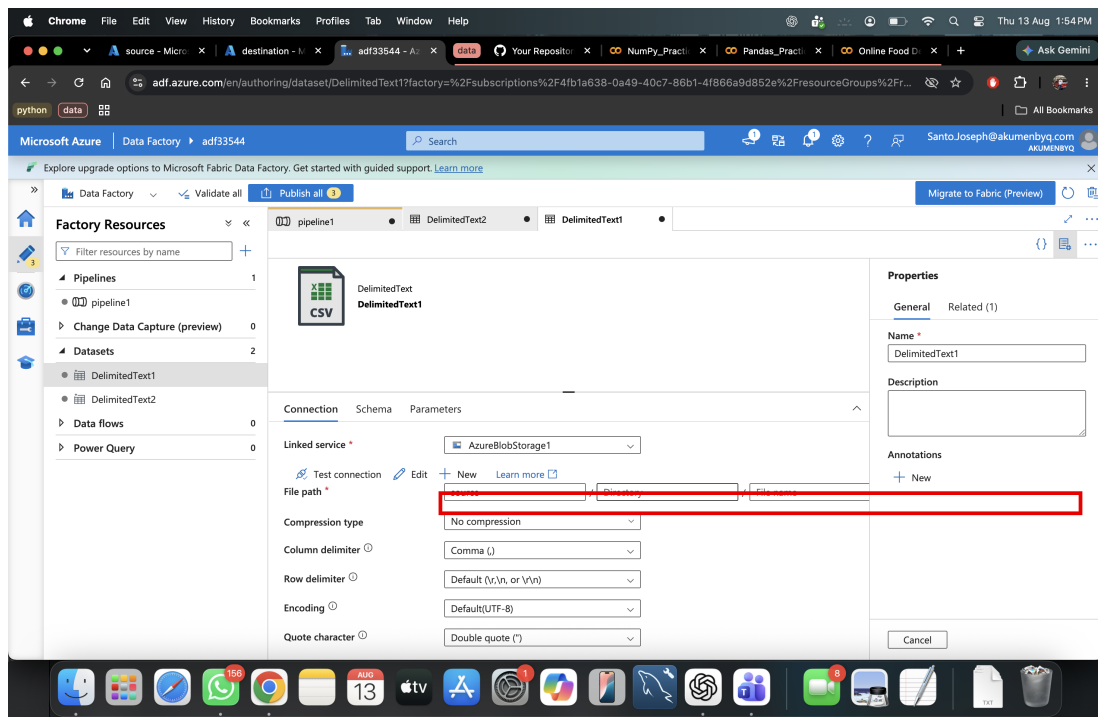
The destination container is cleared out again (0 items), ready for a fresh test run of the pipeline.



The destination container emptied before the next run.

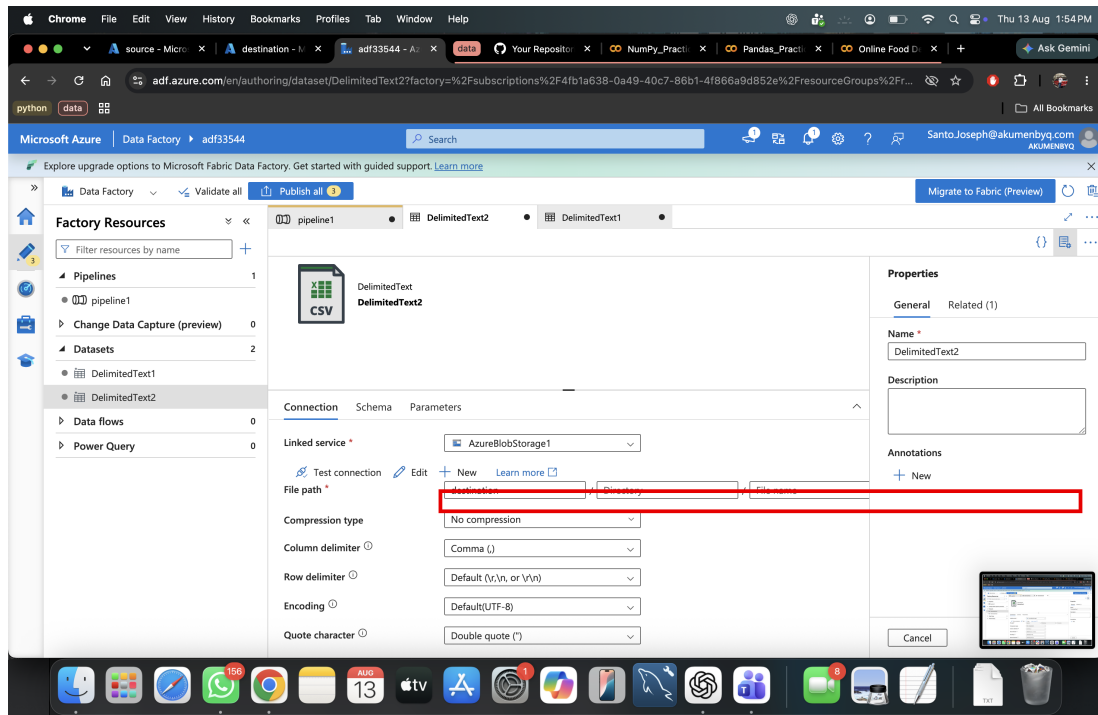
Step 12 — Confirm the dataset connection paths

Open each dataset's **Connection** tab to confirm its file path. **DelimitedText1** (the source dataset) points at the **source** folder...



DelimitedText1 connection: file path = source.

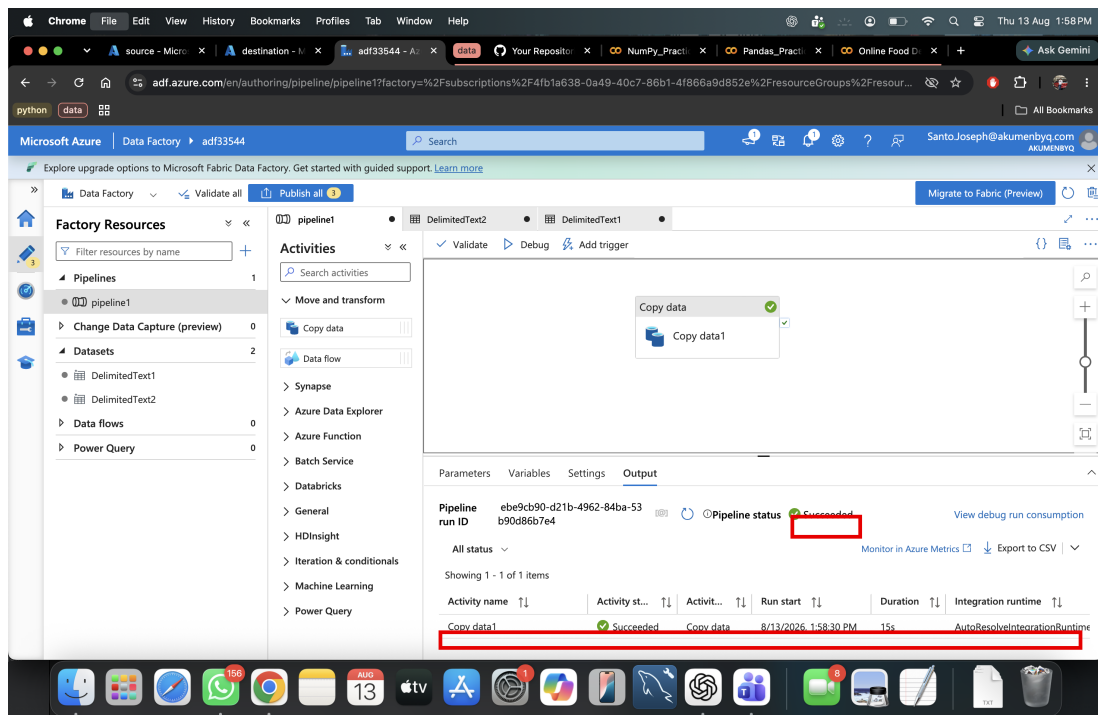
...and **DelimitedText2** (the sink dataset) points at the **destination** folder.



DelimitedText2 connection: file path = destination.

Step 13 — Debug the pipeline again

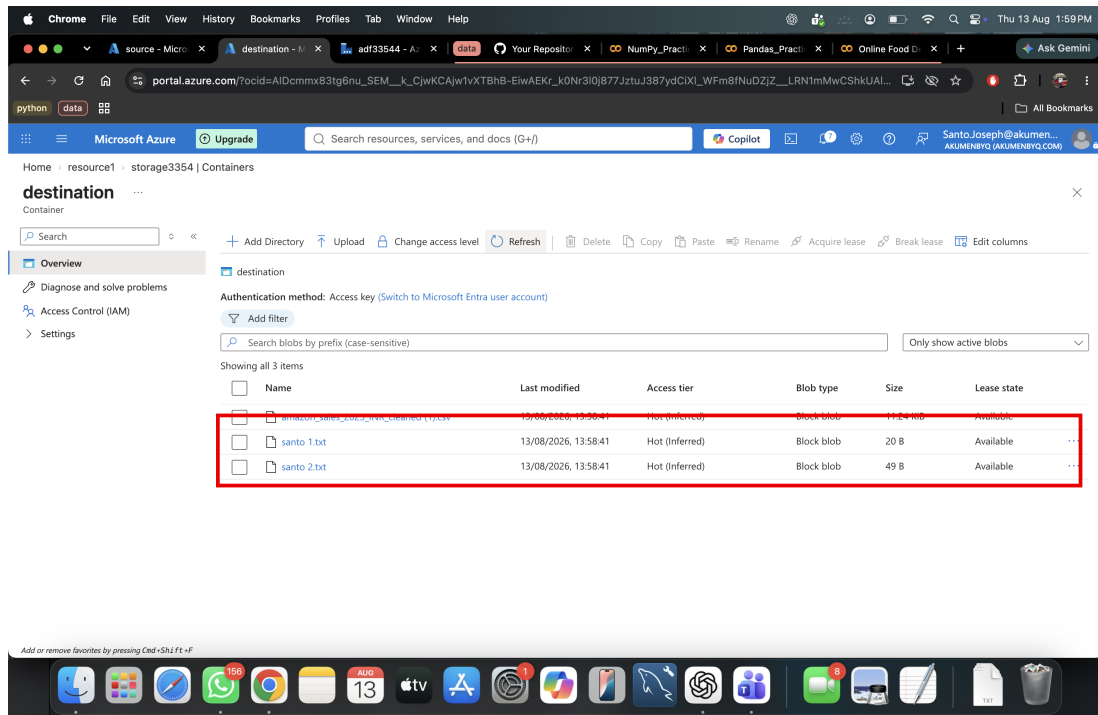
Running **Debug** once more shows the pipeline status as **Succeeded**, with **Copy data1** completing in 15 seconds.



Pipeline status Succeeded, and the Copy data1 activity run details.

Step 14 — Final check of the destination container

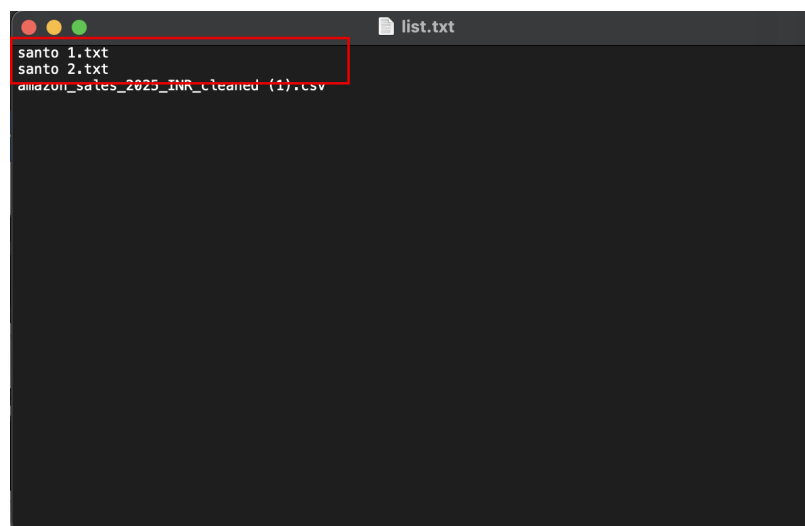
The destination container now holds 3 items: the CSV file plus **santo 1.txt** and **santo 2.txt**, confirming the copy ran successfully end-to-end.



Three files present in the destination container after the run.

Step 15 — Confirm source contents via list.txt

The uploaded **list.txt** file itself lists the filenames that exist in the source container, matching what was seen in the portal.



Contents of list.txt: santo 1.txt, santo 2.txt, amazon_sales_2025_INR_cleaned (1).csv.

Summary

The **Copy data** activity can select which files to move from a source container using either a **Prefix** match (e.g. "santo") or a **Wildcard file path** (e.g. *.csv). Both approaches were verified by running the pipeline in **Debug** mode and confirming the expected files landed in the destination container.